Daniel B. Munro

Computational biologist at UC San Diego
dmunro@health.ucsd.edu https://danmun.ro

EDUCATION

2019 **Ph.D.** Quantitative and Computational Biology, Princeton University
Thesis: Revealing disease-relevant alteration patterns through data aggregation. Advisor: Mona Singh

2013 **B.S.** Biology, University of North Texas

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

05/2025–Present **Assistant Project Scientist**, UC San Diego and
Visiting Scientist, Seattle Children's Research Institute
Palmer Lab (UCSD) and Genomic Data Modeling Lab (SCRI) • Quantitative genetics and regulatory genomics • Integrating genetic variation, multi-modal transcriptomics, and complex traits

05/2023–04/2025 **Bioinformatics Programmer**, UC San Diego and
Visiting Scientist, Seattle Children's Research Institute
Palmer Lab (UCSD) and Genomic Data Modeling Lab (SCRI) • Quantitative genetics and regulatory genomics • Integrating genetic variation, multi-modal transcriptomics, and complex traits

03/2020–04/2023 **Postdoctoral Fellow**, Scripps Research and
Postdoctoral Scholar, UC San Diego
Advisors: Pejman Mohammadi & Abraham Palmer • Quantitative genetics and regulatory genomics • Integrating genetic variation, multi-modal transcriptomics, and complex traits

03/2019–10/2019 **Postdoctoral Associate**, New York University
Advisor: Christine Vogel • Computational research in proteomics and cancer genomics

01/2014–12/2018 **Graduate Research Assistant**, Princeton University
Advisor: Mona Singh • Computational research in cancer genomics, protein variant impact, and histological image analysis

01/2011–05/2013 **Undergraduate Research Assistant**, University of North Texas
Advisor: Qunfeng Dong • Computational microbiome research and genomics software development

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

D Munro, A Gusev, AA Palmer, P Mohammadi. Data-driven RNA phenotyping captures genetically regulated dimensions of the transcriptome. *AJHG* (2026). 113 (7): 1399–1414.

P Campo, R Qiao, MR Doyle, **D Munro**, BB Johnson, AA Palmer, M Kallupi, G de Guglielmo. Ivermectin reduces withdrawal-induced alcohol intake in rats: Association with CeA GABAergic enhancement and *P2rx4* genetic liability. *Neuropharmacology* (2026). 289: 110881.

Center for AI Safety, Scale AI, HLE Contributors Consortium (**D Munro** is a member). A benchmark of expert-level academic questions to assess AI capabilities. *Nature* (2026). 649: 1139-1146.

N Santhanam, S Sanchez-Roige, S Mi, Y Liang, AS Chitre, **D Munro**, D Chen, et al. RatXcan: A framework for cross-species integration of genome-wide association and gene expression data. *PLOS Genetics* (2025). 21(3): e1011583.

EK Hebda-Bauer, MH Hagenauer, **DB Munro**, P Blandino Jr., F Meng, K Arakawa, JDH Stead, et al. Bioenergetic-related gene expression in the hippocampus predicts internalizing vs. externalizing behavior in an animal model of temperament. *Frontiers in Molecular Neuroscience* (2025). 18:1469467.

D Munro, N Ehsan, SM Esmaeili-Fard, A Gusev, AA Palmer, P Mohammadi. Multimodal analysis of RNA sequencing data powers discovery of complex trait genetics. *Nature Communications* (2024). 15: 10387.

F Okamoto, AS Chitre, TM Sanches, D Chen, **D Munro**, AT Aron, A Beeson, et al. Y and mitochondrial chromosomes in the heterogeneous stock rat population. *G3 Genes|Genomes|Genetics* (2024). jkae213.

TV de Jong, Y Pan, P Rastas, **D Munro**, M Tutaj, H Akil, C Benner, et al. A revamped rat reference genome improves the discovery of genetic diversity in laboratory rats. *Cell Genomics* (2024). 4 (4): 100527.

R Clifford, **D Munro**, D Dochtermann, P Devineni, S Pyarajan, Million Veteran Program, F Telese, et al. Genome-wide association study of chronic dizziness in the elderly identifies loci implicating *MLLT10*, *BPTF*, *LINC01224*, and *ROS1*. *JARO* (2023). 24: 575-591.

JL Zhou, G de Guglielmo, AJ Ho, M Kallupi, N Pokhrel, H-R Li, AS Chitre, **D Munro**, et al. Single-nucleus genomics in outbred rats with divergent cocaine addiction-like behaviors reveals changes in amygdala GABAergic inhibition. *Nature Neuroscience* (2023). 26: 1868–1879.

AS Chitre, O Polesskaya, **D Munro**, R Cheng, P Mohammadi, K Holl, J Gao, et al. Exponential increase in QTL detection with increased sample size. *GENETICS* (2023). 224 (2): iyad054.

S Fowler, T Wang, **D Munro**, A Kumar, AS Chitre, TJ Hollingsworth, A Garcia Martinez, et al. Genome-wide association study finds multiple loci associated with intraocular pressure in HS rats. *Frontiers in Genetics* (2023). 13: 1029058.

D Munro, T Wang, AS Chitre, O Polesskaya, N Ehsan, J Gao, A Gusev, LC Solberg Woods, LM Saba, H Chen, AA Palmer, P Mohammadi. The regulatory landscape of multiple brain regions in outbred heterogeneous stock rats. *Nucleic Acids Research* (2022). 50 (19): 10882–10895.

JT Ash*, G Darnell*, **D Munro***, BE Engelhardt. Joint analysis of gene expression levels and histological images identifies genes associated with tissue morphology. *Nature Communications* (2021). 12 (1): 1–12.
* These authors contributed equally

D Munro, M Singh. DeMaSk: A deep mutational scanning substitution matrix and its use for variant impact prediction. *Bioinformatics* (2020). 36 (22–23): 5322–5329.

GXL Li, **D Munro**, D Fermin, C Vogel, H Choi. A protein-centric approach for exome variant aggregation enables sensitive association analysis with clinical outcomes. *Human Mutation* (2020). 41 (5): 934–945.

D Munro, D Ghersi, M Singh. Two critical positions in zinc finger domains are heavily mutated in three human cancer types. *PLoS Comput Biol* (2018). 14 (6): e1006290.

C Cohen, E Toh, **D Munro**, Q Dong, H Hawlena. Similarities and seasonal variations in bacterial communities from the blood of rodents and from their flea vectors. *The ISME Journal* (2015). 2015-01-09.

Y Gavish, H Kedem, I Messika, C Cohen, E Toh, **D Munro**, Q Dong, C Fuqua, K Clay, H Hawlena. Association of host and microbial species diversity across spatial scales in desert rodent communities. *PLoS ONE* (2014). 9: e109677.

JS Kuehn, PJ Gorden, **D Munro**, R Rong, Q Dong, PJ Plummer, C Wang, GJ Phillips. Bacterial community profiling of milk samples as a means to understand culture-negative bovine clinical mastitis. *PLoS ONE*. 8: e61959.

M Zhou, R Rong, **D Munro**, C Zhu, X Gao, Q Zhang, Q Dong (2013). Investigation of the effect of type 2 diabetes mellitus on subgingival plaque microbiota by high-throughput 16S rDNA pyrosequencing. *PLoS ONE* (2013). 8: e61516.

H Hawlena, E Rynkiewicz, E Toh, A Alfred, LA Durden, MW Hastriter, DE Nelson, R Rong, **D Munro**, Q Dong, C Fuqua, K Clay. The arthropod, but not the vertebrate host or its environment, dictates bacterial community composition of fleas and ticks. *The ISME Journal* (2013). 7: 221-223.

K Revanna, **D Munro**, A Gao, C Chiu, A Pathak, Q Dong. A web-based multi-Genome Synteny Viewer for customized data. *BMC Bioinformatics* (2012). 13: 190.

PREPRINTS

AS Chitre, TM Sanches, G Ang, NK Amissah, R Avila, H Bimschleger, P Campo, et al. (**D Munro** is 22nd author). Genomic SEM reveals shared genetic architecture and expands locus discovery for locomotor activity in heterogeneous stock rats.
Preprint: https://www.biorxiv.org/content/10.64898/2026.10.01.756043v1

D Chen, KA Cohen, K-MH Nguyen, HZ Jam, RJ Eveloff, Y Wang, J Guevara, TM Sanches, M Mortazavi, **D Munro**, et al. Point mutations and complex variants impact gene expression and addiction-related behaviors in Heterogeneous Stock rats.
Preprint: https://www.biorxiv.org/content/10.64898/2026.09.10.750683v1

SM Esmaeili-Fard, AX Maihofer, TW Willis, EA Mikita, JA Johnson, **D Munro**, A Kumar, et al. GWAS and multimodal transcriptomic profiling of human otolithic organs characterize the genetic architecture of balance in the elderly.
Preprint: https://www.medrxiv.org/content/10.64898/2026.08.21.26360655v1

C Wu, A Bzikadze, T Xu, E Mendenhall, H Chen, F Telese, O Polesskaya, **D Munro**, AA Palmer, A Goren, M Gymrek. Trex-QTL: A mixture-model for identification of genetic effects with global effects on molecular phenotypes.
Preprint: https://www.biorxiv.org/content/10.64898/2026.08.07.743622v1

KR Ganapathy, E Song, **D Munro**, A Torkamani, P Mohammadi. Allele Specific Expression Quality Control Fills Critical Gap in Transcriptome Assisted Rare Variant Interpretation.
Preprint: https://www.biorxiv.org/content/10.1101/2025.05.30.657086v2

HONORS & AWARDS

2026	Yale/NIDA Neuroproteomics Center Pilot Grant, “Mapping Protein Quantitative Trait Loci in the Heterogeneous Stock Rat Brain to Identify Causal Genes at Substance Use Disorder GWAS Loci”. Role: PI. Total costs: $11,994.
2025	Staff Appreciation and Recognition (STAR) Award for 2024-2025, Department of Psychiatry, UC San Diego
2019	Runner-up, Symbiosis Competition at Imagine Science Film Festival, New York, NY, in collaboration with Jin Angdoo
2013	**National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship**
2013	Phi Kappa Phi National Fellowship ($5000)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Spring 2016	Assistant in Instruction, “An Integrated, Quantitative Introduction to the Natural Sciences II”, Princeton University

Fall 2015 Assistant in Instruction, “An Integrated, Quantitative Introduction to the Natural Sciences I”, Princeton University

PRESENTATIONS

2025 “Deep transcriptomic analysis identifies potential mediators of substance use disorders in rats”, nanosymposium talk at Neuroscience, November 18, 2025

2024 “Multimodal analysis of RNA sequencing data powers discovery of complex trait genetics”, platform talk at RECOMB-Genetics, April 28, 2024

2022 “The regulatory landscape of multiple brain regions in outbred heterogeneous stock rats”, talk at the Complex Trait Consortium-Rat Genomics 2022 meeting, September 29, 2022

2021 “Identification of regulatory landscape in multiple brain regions of outbred heterogeneous stock rats”, talk at the Complex Trait Consortium-Rat Genomics 2021 meeting, September 1, 2021

2021, 2023 “Techniques for algorithmic graphics”, guest lecture for Honors Colloquium on Complex Systems, University of Nebraska Omaha, March 2, 2021 and March 28, 2023

2020 “Mapping eQTLs in five rat brain regions”, talk at the 6th Annual Retreat for P50 Center for GWAS in Outbred Rats, La Jolla, CA, November 2, 2020

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE & MEMBERSHIPS

ISCB Great Plains Bioinformatics Conference Program Committee member, Omaha, NE, September 28-30, 2026

Test subject in NASA’s Exploration Atmosphere study at Johnson Space Center, Houston, TX
EA6 Mission 2: July 25 to August 1, 2025
EA9 (backup crewmember): September 9-29, 2026

Active member of the Multi-Omics and Human analysis working groups for the NASA Open Science Data Repository. https://awg.osdr.space/u/danielmunro

Judge for NASA’s GL4HS (GeneLab for High Schools) Capstone Showcase, September 6, 2025 and August 8, 2026

Ad hoc peer reviewer for:
Developmental Biology (2019)
PLOS Computational Biology (2020)
PLOS ONE (2020)
BMC Bioinformatics (2021)

Journal of Computational Biology (2021)
Genome Biology (2023)
IEEE/ACM Transactions on Computational Biology and Bioinformatics (2023)
The American Journal of Human Genetics (2023)
Neuropsychopharmacology (2024)
Nature Communications (2024)
PLOS Genetics (2026)

Memberships:
Society for Neuroscience (Since 2025)
American Society of Human Genetics (Since 2020)
International Society for Computational Biology (Since 2019)

CERTIFICATIONS

Initial Physiological Training Course – NASA (Houston, TX, 2024-11-07)
Open Water Diver – PADI (2024-07-28)
Amateur Radio License, General Class – FCC (2024-06-25)